

28 > AI as your creative catalyst

Over weeks, you build a personal knowledge base – which you can later feed back into AI (“Based on my notes on AI ethics, suggest a blog outline”).

Summarising books (ethically)

Full-book summarisation by dumping an entire ePub/PDF into an AI tool raises copyright issues, so tread carefully and use legal copies you own for personal learning.

A more sustainable pattern:

- Summarise your own highlights, notes and quotes, not the entire book.
- Or use AI to structure and clarify what you already captured.

Prompt for that:

“Here are my highlights and notes from reading [Book Title]:
[paste your notes]

1. Group them into 5–7 themes.
2. For each theme, write a short explanation in my own tone (simple, conversational).
3. Then suggest 3 practical experiments I can try this month using ideas from this book.”

This way, AI becomes your thinking partner, not a piracy partner.

3. Use AI for writing blogs, poems, stories

ChatGPT, Gemini and similar tools are now mainstream creative partners – used to brainstorm, outline and polish everything from newsletters to scripts.

The trick is to keep your voice, and let AI do the boring or “stuck” parts.

Blog/article workflow

Step 1 – Idea dump

Tell ChatGPT/Gemini:

“You are my blog writing assistant.

Here are 5 topics I’m interested in writing about: [list].

1. Suggest 10 specific article angles that feel fresh and not generic listicles.
2. Mark 3 of them as ‘low effort / high impact’ for busy weeks.”
Pick one.

Step 2 – Outline

“For angle [X], create a detailed outline:

- Hook
- 3–5 main sections
- Example/story ideas for each section
- Suggested title and 3 alternative titles.”

Step 3 – First draft (with guardrails)

“Now draft the article following this outline in my voice:

- Tone: [wry / straightforward / explanatory / Jason-style tech explainer, etc.]
- Audience: [Indian general tech readers / indie creators / etc.]
- Length: ~1200 words

Don’t sound like a marketing copy; sound like a human who has actually used these tools.”

Read the draft. Keep what works, rewrite what doesn’t.

Step 4 – Personalise & polish

Paste your edited version back and say:

“This is my revised draft.

1. Highlight any paragraphs that feel repetitive or draggy.
2. Suggest punchier alternatives for the headline and intro.
3. Fix grammar and flow while preserving my tone.”

Now you’ve shortened your “time to publish” significantly, without losing authorship.

Poems and stories: AI as collaborator, not ghostwriter

You can use AI to:

- Generate story prompts
- Explore “what if” branches
- Develop characters, worlds, and arcs

Character/world bible:

“I’m writing a short story set in [time/place].

Main character: [describe].

Tone: [e.g. slice-of-life with subtle humour].

1. Help me flesh out 3 supporting characters with quirks and motivations.
2. Suggest 5 possible conflicts that fit this world.

